Struggle Research Centre[17] and is most revealing, as it is Bhagat Singh's detailed address to the young political workers on 2 February 1931. Here he leaves no doubt that '[t]he present movement is bound to end in some sort of compromise. The compromise may be effected sooner or later. And, compromise is not such an ignoble and deplorable a thing as we generally think. It is rather an indispensable factor in the political strategy. Any nation that rises against the oppressor is bound to fail in the beginning' so that 'it is only at the last stage . . . that it can possibly strike the final blow'. However, as he explains, 'even then it might fail, which makes some sort of compromise inevitable'. He gives the example of how after 1917 'the Bolsheviks were not in a position to face the German onslaught and they preferred the [Brest Litovsk] Treaty to the complete annihilation of the Bolshevik Government'. After giving this as an example, Bhagat Singh is clear he is not accepting defeat in compromise because 'for us, compromise never means surrender, but a step forward and some rest,' thus exhibiting acute strategic acumen.

This suggests that had Lord Irwin only been willing to bend a little, Bhagat Singh may well have compromised and negotiated with him. For Bhagat Singh,

> compromise is an essential weapon which has to be wielded every now and then as the struggle develops. But the thing that we must keep always before us is the idea of the movement. We must always maintain a clear notion as to the aim for the achievement of which we are fighting. That helps us to verify the success and failures of our movements . . .[18]

Moffat expressed the opinion here that 'even if Bhagat Singh would, in a later essay written in prison, accept the possibility of compromise as part of the "medieval period" of a struggle, what was crucial to the revolutionaries' early actions and public performance was their emphasis on courage and conviction as the conditions for an effective politics'.[19]

It is this courage and conviction that impels Bhagat Singh to oppose so vehemently 'the Minto-Morley Reforms . . . which formed the Viceroy's council with consultation rights only'. He complains of how, 'during the